

Altered State Publishing Designing Workflows for Alternative Publishing

Students research an exhibition catalog, write a counter-narrative, and design a faux page – published directly into the book. **We love pedagogy, but our systems treat this as damage.** How do we treat it as publishing?

WORKSHOP SESSION

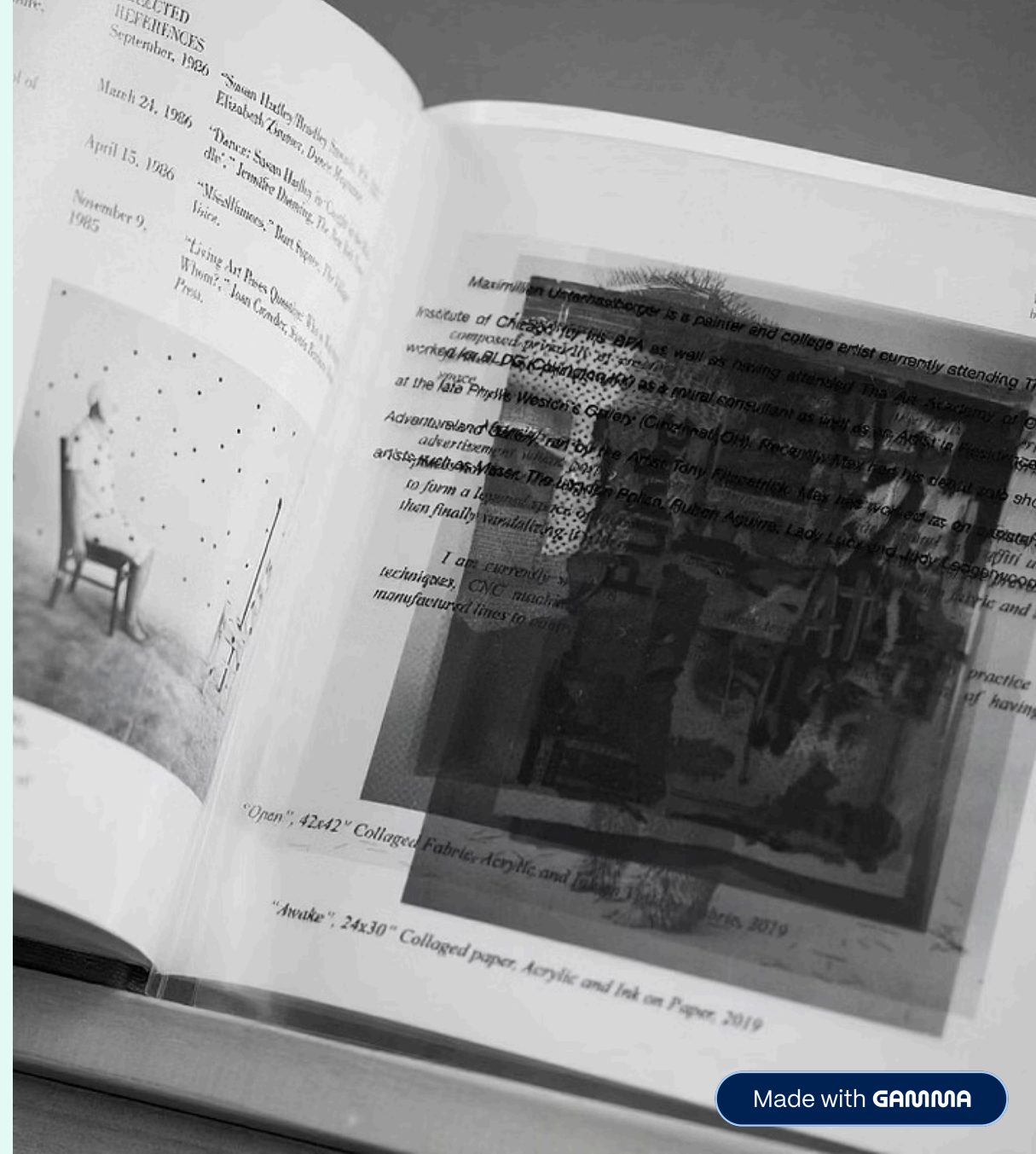
10 + 30 + 10 MIN



The Provocation

What happens when an object asks to be read, handled, described, preserved, and circulated, but does not fit the systems built to manage those things?

Zines, pamphlets, artist publications, and other small press objects often resist easy classification. They may be handmade, irregular, anonymous, collaborative, or produced in very small numbers. They blur the line between publication and artifact, between record and intervention. Before we ask how to catalog or collect them, we might first ask: what assumptions do our systems make about authorship, authority, format, value, and permanence?



Mini Zine

Create a mini zine about a text that has been challenged, dismissed, debated, or overlooked. Your zine should take a position: defend it, critique it, reinterpret it, or argue why it belongs in a collection. (10 Mins)

Choose a text that is:

- banned or challenged
- controversial
- widely loved but you disagree with
- widely dismissed but you think matters
- not usually treated as “scholarly”
- personally meaningful and worth preserving

Anatomy of Your Mini Zine

Here's a breakdown of the core elements to include in your mini zine, guiding you through the narrative arc of your critical response.



Page One: Title

The original book's title and author.



Inside Spread 1: Consensus

What the critics, scholars, or public generally say about the text.



Inside Spread 2: Your Voice

Your personal critique, defense, or reinterpretation.



Inside Spread 3: Intervention

One specific thing you would add, change, or challenge in the book.



Back Cover: Your Mark

Your name, alias, or chosen identifier.

Text Ideas

A selection of titles to get your brain whirring.



Gender Queer The Da Vinci Code And Tango Makes Three Guns, Germs and Steel
The Alchemist A People's History of the United States Stamped from the Beginning Americanah
Goodnight Moon Men are from Mars, Women are from Venus Outliers
The Second Sex Wuthering Heights Giovanni's Room Distinction
Sweet Valley High James Patterson The 1619 Project Discipline and Punish
All Boys Aren't Blue Captain Underpants Warrior Cats
Sister Outsider Infinite Jest Perks of Being a Wallflower The Bluest Eye
Animorphs The 4-Hour Workweek The Giving Tree The Bible Gender Trouble
Black Boy Fahrenheit 451 Harry Potter The Catcher in the Rye Ulysses The Color Purple
Dune The Hate U Give House of Leaves Pedagogy of the Oppressed Caste Invisible Man
Lolita Stone Butch Blues 50 Shades of Grey Tuesdays with Morrie
Colleen Hoover The Secret Babysitter's Club The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn
How to be an Antiracist

Mini Zine

What you just made is a physical intervention into a field of meaning.

By folding paper, selecting language, adding images, and shaping a small publication, you did more than express an opinion. You entered into relation with other texts in a visible, material way. Your zine does not sit outside scholarship. It interrupts it, extends it, and reframes it. It makes argument tangible.



The Breakout: Infrastructure Design

Participants split into two working "Departments" – each handed a physical book with a student insert and a focused design prompt.

Group 1: The Editors

Policy & Ethics

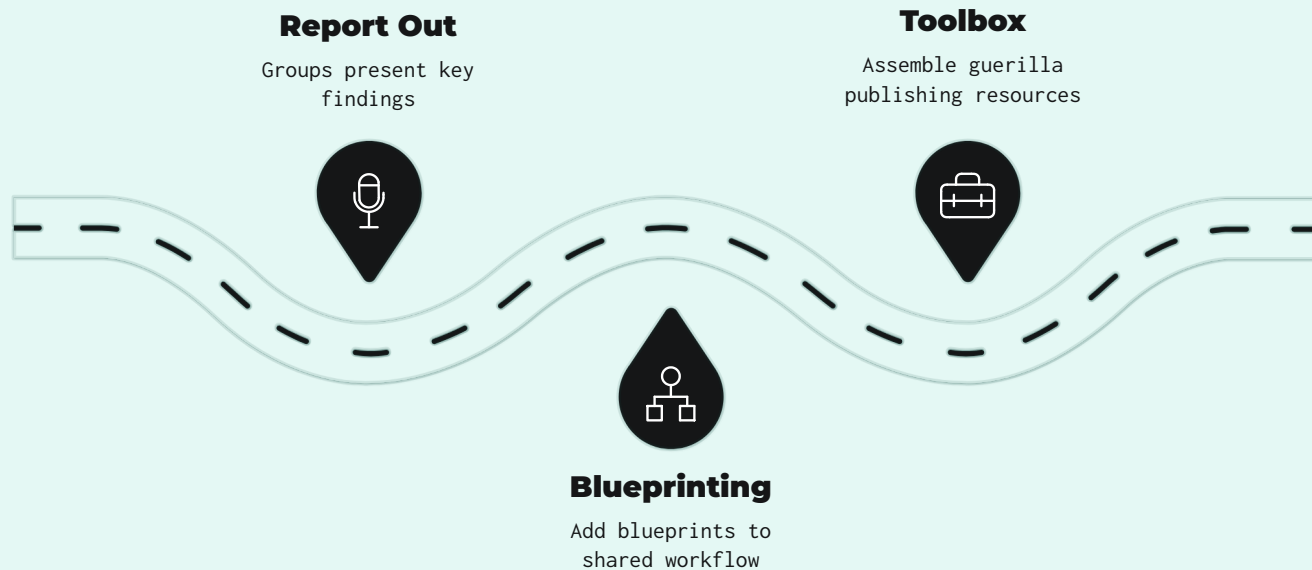
- Write the "Acceptance Criteria" – who approves what gets inserted?
- Design a peer review process for student-authored content
- Resolve copyright questions around the original text

Group 2: The Catalogers

Discovery & Metadata

- Spine sticker, MARC record note, or QR code to the IR?
- Make the intervention findable – without erasing the original
- Draft a metadata schema for student interventions

The Blueprinting: Building Live



Each group doesn't just share ideas – they add their blueprint directly to a projected, shared digital workflow. The toolbox is built in real time, capturing both outputs and recorded conversation.

Policy Drafts

Acceptance criteria and ethics frameworks (Group 1)

Metadata Schemas

Discovery solutions and cataloging workflows (Group 2)

Recorded Dialogue

Live conversation captured as part of the toolbox artifact

What was missing?

What aspects of this process were missing when comparing it to normal workflows? What questions were not answered that would have helped? What questions have opened up new ways of thinking for you? What departments don't have input?

Help us generate as many new questions as possible...

The Takeaway: Your Guerilla Publishing Toolbox

Leave with a shared link to everything built today – policy drafts, workflow diagrams, and metadata schemas, ready to adapt for your institution.



Design Charrette Model

Borrowed from studio art pedagogy – you prototype, not just listen



Adaptable Infrastructure

Every output is institution-agnostic and ready to remix



Shared & Open

The toolbox lives beyond this room – contribute, fork, and build on it

📌 **The provocation stands:** If a student's counter-narrative belongs in the collection, our infrastructure should make that possible – not treat it as an accident.

